

Standard Chartered

First Take: >15% RoTE by 2028 in line, but capital return target may slightly disappoint; reiterate OW

StanChart's >15% RoTE target by 2028 is broadly in line with JPMe (15.5%), but with expectations having built up – particularly following the strong 1Q print – we expect a muted near-term share price reaction. However, StanChart has historically been conservative in target-setting, focusing on beating rather than stretching expectations. We reiterate our OW rating on STAN, as the sustainable growth plan underpins a double-digit EPS CAGR trajectory delivering RoTE expansion from 11.9% in 2025 to >15% in 2028 and then ~18% by 2030. The Group now targets a dividend payout ratio of ≥30% (vs JPMe 35%) with a progressive DPS, and the capital target range of 13-14% remains unchanged. The strategic focus remains on: 1) Wealth income, targeted to grow to c75% of Wealth & Retail income by 28E (vs 70% FY25), 2) Cross-border income, targeted to grow to c70% of CIB income 28E (vs 66% FY25), 3) Financial Institutions income, targeted to grow to c60% of CIB income (vs 54% FY25), which together are expected to drive +380bps of ROTE improvement across the plan and which underpins the longer-term trajectory of ROTE. We believe the current valuations of 7.9x PE, 1.2x PTNAV for a ROTE of 15.5% 28E do not reflect these long-term ROTE targets and we await further details to assess.

- **STAN has set out sustainable growth plan, comprising:** 1) RoTE of >15% by 2028 (a >3pp uplift from 2025), building to ~18% by 2030; 2) a high-teens EPS CAGR and a 5-7% income CAGR over 2025-2028; 3) a cost-to-income ratio of ~57% by 2028 (from 63% in 2025), supported by positive income-to-cost jaws; 4) ~20% improvement in income per employee by 2028, with corporate functions headcount reduction of >15% by 2030; 5) a CET1 ratio operating range of 13-14% and through-the-cycle loan loss ratio of 30-35bps; 6) a dividend payout ratio of ≥30% with progressive DPS; and 7) \$200bn of Net New Money, and Affluent income to reach 75% of its total by 2028 (accelerated from 2029). In addition, STAN announced the appointment of Manus Costello as Group CFO, subject to regulatory approval, effective immediately on an interim basis. Mr. Costello joined STAN in April 2024 as Global Head of Investor Relations, having previously spent 25 years in equity research, including as a founding partner and Global Head of Research at Autonomous.
- **Comparison with JPMe – broadly in line.** Positive: 1) RoTE building to ~18% by 2030 is a newly announced target. In line: 1) >15% RoTE in 2028 (vs JPMe 15.5%); 2) 2025-2028 income CAGR of 5-7% (vs JPMe 5.5%); 3) high-teens EPS CAGR (vs JPMe 18.6%). We note that there was: 1) No change to the CET1 target range at 13-14% (vs the JPMe of a narrower 13-13.5%), though this does not impact our buyback estimate (\$2bn/\$2.5bn/\$2.5bn in 2026/27/28E) as our 26-28E CET1 ratio solves for c13.3% (pro-forma SBBs) annually, within the guided range. 2) 2028 CIR of ~57% (vs JPMe 56%). 3) No updated 2026 NII guidance, despite market expectations of an upward revision following the strong 1Q trajectory, although we await further details on this.
- **We expect a muted share price reaction in the near term:** The FY28 ROTE

Overweight

STAN.L, STAN LN

Price (18 May 26):1,922p

Price Target (Dec-27):2220.0p

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target of >15% is in line with JPMe and company-compiled consensus, which stood at 15.1% before the 1Q release and has likely been revised up following the strong 1Q print. However, the market may view the capital management target as a slight miss, given the lack of buyback guidance and no revision to the CET1 target range. We expect the stock to stay flattish or edge slightly lower when the market opens.

Table 1: Summary of medium-term targets

Key metrics	STAN's medium term target	JPMe
Stated ROTE	>15% in 2028, and building to ~18% in 2030	15.5% in 2028
EPS CAGR (25-28E)	High-teens CAGR	18.6% CAGR
Revenue CAGR (25-28E)	5-7% 2025-28 CAGR	5.6% CAGR
Cost-to-income ratio	~57% in 2028, positive cost-income jaws each year over 2025-2028	~56% in 2028
Productivity improvements	Raise income per employee by ~20% by 2028, >15% reduction in corporate functions headcount by 2030	NA
CET1 operating range	Operate throughout 13-14% target range	Narrowed to 13-13.5%
Loan loss ratio	30-35bps through-the-cycle	NA
Dividend payout	30% or more, with progressive DPS	35% payout ratio
Wealth	- Targeting \$200bn of Net New Money over 2025-28 (prev 2025-29) - Affluent income to reach 75% of WRB by 2028 (prev 2029) - Double-digit Wealth Income CAGR 2025-28 (prev 2025-29)	- Net new money \$235bn 2025-28 - Affluent income c80% of WRB in 2028 - c18% Wealth income CAGR 2025-28
CIB	Network income as a % of CIB income of 70% in 2028	

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Company data.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

Standard Chartered (Overweight; Price Target: 2220.0p)

Investment Thesis

We view StanChart as undervalued relative to sector/EM peers at 1.2x PTNAV 27E with significant earnings growth potential supported by structural growth drivers and relatively high capital return. With the Group's 24-26E targets already achieved by FY25 across revenues and distributions, we now forecast c5.5% revenue growth CAGR across '25-28E driven by non-NII in 26, and broadening out to both NII/non-NII in outer years. We see this led by Wealth (driven by Affluent segment opportunities), Financial Markets (alongside cross-border income) and Banking. We expect FY26E NII +2% y/y due to lower rates and pass-throughs offset by volume growth. We expect cost growth at a c1% CAGR 25-28E as we expect growing investments in the future to capitalise on productivity and revenue opportunities, with positive operating leverage expected annually and the CIR to decline towards mid-50s. Overall, we expect stated ROTE to grow to c15.5% 28E, alongside a 35% dividend payout ratio and \$2-2.5bn/y buybacks, offering a total yield of 7-9%/y.

Valuation

We value StanChart using a SOTP methodology with divisional multiples differentiated by type of business. We value Corporate, Commercial and Institutional Banking at 8.5x P/E, and Consumer, Private & Business Banking Commercial at 10.0x P/E. We value excess capital above 13.0% at 1x. Our Dec-27 PT is 2,200p.

StanChart SOP

£m								
£ MILLION Division	Post Tax Profit 2028E	Allocated B4 Equity 2028E	RWAs £ bn 2028E	Valuation Basis	£ mn Value	£ Per Share	(x) PE	(x) P/BV
Corporate, Commercial & Institutional Banking	3,777	21,314	164.0	P/E	32,108	15.99	8.5	
Consumer, Private and Business Banking	2,408	6,254	48.1	P/E	24,085	11.99	10.0	
Corporate centre and other	-1,016	2,680	20.6	P/E	-9,141	-4.55	9.0	
Capital Excess		1,959		1 times BV	1,959	0.98		1.0
Standard Chartered Group	5,170	32,207	232.7		49,011	24.4	9.5	
Standard Chartered Group (Dec-2027)						22.2		

J.P. Morgan estimates.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

- **Macro-economic risks:** Being an EM-focused bank, StanChart is exposed to general macro-economic risk in EM such as slowdowns, inflationary pressures, depreciation of EM currencies and cross-border and political risks. COVID-19 continues to be a risk towards revenues and impairments in the near term, particularly in Asian economies, as well as geopolitical tensions creating a potential headwind.
- **Provisioning outlook:** We expect provisions at normalised levels across the medium term given growing pressures in the economic environment. An increase or decrease in provisions as a result of the economic outlook or with regards to specific cases poses a risk to our forecasts.

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Standard Chartered (STAN.L, STAN LN) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Jun 27, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price (p)	Price Target (p)
01-Aug-23	OW	747	980
07-Sep-23	OW	702	990
16-Jan-24	OW	605	820
26-Feb-24	OW	635	850
10-Apr-24	OW	673	900
03-May-24	OW	756	1,000
31-Jul-24	OW	770	1,020
04-Dec-24	OW	966	1,180
24-Feb-25	OW	1183	1,390
04-Aug-25	OW	1355	1,490
09-Sep-25	OW	1391	1,670
17-Oct-25	OW	1428	1,690
03-Nov-25	OW	1560	1,770
02-Dec-25	OW	1681	1,880
05-Feb-26	OW	1857	2,170
25-Feb-26	OW	1789	2,200
06-May-26	OW	1819	2,220

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